



AFTER

As the years passed, the Union's superiority became increasingly apparent in developments such as the use of new weapons and transportation systems.

FASTER FIREPOWER

A key innovation was to arm Union cavalymen with **breech-loading repeating rifles** that used metallic cartridges. The most famous of these was the **Spencer carbine** (see [Roles of the cavalry](#)). Previous firearms required a complicated loading process involving a paper cartridge, ramrod, and percussion cap. With the new firearms, a soldier simply pulled a lever to get rid of the spent cartridge, allowing him to fire multiple shots.

RAPID REPAIR

Transportation innovations included **rapid railroad repair and protection** inside Union territory, demonstrated by Sherman's use of a railroad for resupply during the Atlanta campaign (see [Sherman's Advance to Atlanta](#)). Meigs also organized seaborne resupply for Sherman after his [March to the Sea](#).